

realm on his motorcycle. We're never actually shown if Dante returns, but we do see Lucia later on at Devil Never Cry going out to investigate the sounds of a motorcycle.

DMC3 is set years before the first DMC and features a younger and cockier Dante. The game starts at the yet-to-be-named shop when a huge ass tower emerges from the ground. Dante can sense Vergil at the top and sees this as a challenge and starts making his way to the top. Once he makes it to the tower's summit and faces Vergil, he loses and Vergil takes Dante's half of the amulet. However, this awakens Dante's dormant demon powers and he's able to use Devil Trigger for the first time.

Vergil intends to harness the full power of Sparda and embrace his demonic side. But in order to do so he needed both halves of the amulet. Now that he had them, he intended to activate the tower – Temen-ni-gru – and connect the realm of humans and demons. Basically the tower was like a gate, and the amulet was the key. But for some reason Vergil couldn't activate the tower, when Dante reaches him they battle, but they're interrupted by Arkham, who was pulling strings behind the scenes in order to activate the tower. Arkham activates the tower and enters the demon realm to assume the Force Edge and Sparda's power. Dante makes his way to the summit again and enters the demon realm to face Arkham who is now big demonic blob, albeit a really strong demonic blob.

During his fight with Arkham, Vergil reappears and the twins work together to defeat Arkham and expel him from the demonic realm. Dante and Vergil fight each other again, this time over ownership of the Force Edge. Vergil loses and chooses to remain in the demon realm with his half of the amulet.

DMC4 has us playing as Nero for the first half of the game and Dante for the second half. Nero is a demon hunter for The Order of the Sword, a cult of people who worship Sparda. Dante

shows up during one of their ceremonies and kills their High Priest Sanctus. Credo – who leads The Order of Holy Knights – tells Nero to stall Dante while The Order got everyone to safety. Nero actually manages to overwhelm Dante (Dante totally let him win btw) and Dante reveals that The Order members he killed were actually demons before leaving. Credo tasks Nero with stopping Dante at Fortuna Castle. There Nero finds out that Order member Agnus has been experimenting on Yamato, Vergil's long lost sword and using its demonic energy to create an army of demons. He has also created Hell Gates throughout the castle.

Nero fights Agnus and is able to defeat him after unlocking his demonic potential thanks to Yamato.

Nero rushes back to Order HQ to find a huge statue which Sanctus calls "The Savior". The Saviour can only be awakened by the Force Edge or the Yamato, and the blood of Sparda. Turns out Nero has Sparda's blood and Sanctus already has the Force Edge. And so Sanctus absorbs Nero into The Savior.

Gameplay

Gameplay wise DMC has remained mostly consistent across all titles. It's primarily a hack n' slash game and the main focus is on flashy and stylish combat. You have to string combos together and avoid being hit. This in turn increases your style gauge and gives you a style grade. The grades range from D to S, or even SSS in some cases, with S being the best grade. Players needed to vary their attacks and switch weapons around to maintain and increase the gauge. Guns and other ranged weapons don't require ammo don't need to be reloaded. Devil May Cry 3 introduced combat styles to the game as well. Players could variate between them. The Trickster style for example, gave you better agility and dodging abilities while the Swordmaster style gave you more melee based abilities.

There are platforming and puzzle solving elements incorporated as well but combat remains the primary focus. So if you're into flashy combat, epic boss fights, and the hack n' slash genre in general, you might want to consider getting yourself a DMC game. You won't be disappointed. *

